

Section A

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Q1

→ Hardware - the tangible physical parts of a computer.

Examples: CPU, SSD.

Software - the intangible programs and data that tell the hardware what to do.

Examples: OS, Spotify.

Q2

→ OS is a layer between user programs and hardware.

1. Manages resources
2. Provides abstraction
3. Controls hardware via drivers

Q3

→ Machine code is a stream of binary instructions (0s and 1s) that a CPU can execute directly.

→ High level languages (Python, C++) must be translated into machine code because a processor can only understand its own instruction set architecture.

Q4

^(faster)
Compiler
converts entire source file to machine code before exe.

Stand alone binary

^(slower)
Interpreter
Translates and executes line by line at runtime.
No separate binary.

RAM

volatile
nanoseconds access

working memory
for active programs
and data.

SSD.

non-volatile
milliseconds or
micro seconds access.

long term storage.

Q5 $(110101)_2 \rightarrow ()_{10}$

$$1(2^5) + 1(2^4) + 0(2^3) + 1(2^2) + 0(2^1) + 1(2^0) \\ = (53)_{10}$$

Q6 ADC

→ Sampling - Measure the analog signal's amplitude at uniform time intervals

→ Quantization - Round each sample's amplitude to the nearest level representable with a fixed number of bits.

→ Encoding - Store each quantized value as a binary word. The resulting bit stream is the digital version of the original analog signal.

Q7

- Significance: Limits the SNR and fidelity of digital audio, images, etc.
- Minimization: Use more bits per sample (finer steps), apply dithering or use noise shaping techniques.

Q8

- Readable, concise syntax - speeds up prototyping and collaboration.
- Rich ecosystem - libraries like Numpy, Pandas, scikitlearn, Tensorflow, PyTorch.
- Large community & resources - abundant tutorials, forums, and pre-trained models.

Q9

- `.py` → plain text python script
- `.ipynb` → jupyter notebook file, json format containing code cells, output, and markdown, executed interactively in a browser.

Q10

- Interactive mode → type commands at a prompt (`>>>`) or in a Jupyter cell and see immediate results. Best for quick testing, exploration and data analysis.
- Script mode → write code in .py and run it as a whole. Best for larger programs, automation and version control matter.

Section B

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